



Self-balancing bike

Ever wondered how Honda's self-balancing motor cycle works? Read on to find out the answer. <http://digit.in/hhsdmc>



Geeky Movie facts

Consider yourself a movie goer? Let us know if you knew every single one of these 82 facts. <http://digit.in/82moviefacts>

RESOURCE USAGE

ELEMENTARY

Looking at the number of installed applications out-of-the-box, resource usage should obviously be low. After some time idling, without any applications running in the background except System Monitor, we saw 953 MB being used out of the available 3.8 GB. That's 24.7 percent of the total memory. Playing a YouTube video pushed the memory usage to 1.3 GB. As we opened up five tabs in Epiphany, the usage jumped to 2.4 GB. Having 10 tabs open in the browser almost maxed out the available memory at around 3.5 GB, leading to a terrible browsing experience. This is only with Epiphany since Firefox used only 2.3 GB with 10 tabs open.

ENSO

Sitting idle with no applications running (except System Monitor), the operating system was using about 1.2 GB out of the available 3.8 GB of memory. This is about 31.7 percent of the total available memory. With 20 tabs open in Firefox and one among them playing a video on YouTube, memory usage jumped to 2.8 GB. With just one extra tab loading, the active tab displayed some stutter while scrolling. We recommend using this OS on a system with 4 GB of RAM or higher. Multitasking can be a problem, for example, when you're editing images on GIMP while browsing the web.

MULTIMEDIA PLAYBACK

ELEMENTARY

As stated earlier, we didn't like the experience on Epiphany and went on to use Firefox instead. Another issue is that it doesn't support resolutions higher than 720p, nor does it support the web players of Amazon Prime Video and Netflix. While watching YouTube videos, until 2K we had no issues and rarely felt stutters if the mouse was moved. 4K videos are unwatchable. Most of our local test samples successfully played in the default music and video player. We didn't experience any issues with high bit-rate videos but 4K videos stuttered a lot.

ENSO

As a daily driver, watching YouTube videos is an important aspect. While we had no problems with playing videos at 1080p or lower resolutions, it wasn't a pleasant experience beyond that. At 2K resolution (1440p), any kind of interaction with the YouTube web player would lead to dropped frames. 4K videos are completely unwatchable. We tried this out on the default Firefox web browser. For local playback support, all the general audio formats (including FLAC) and video are supported.

MOBILE DEVICE SUPPORT

ELEMENTARY

Connecting Android devices was a breeze and both our devices, the OnePlus X and Mi 5 instantly paired with the machine. However, all our attempts at sharing files via Bluetooth were unsuccessful. To check iOS connectivity, we used an iPad Pro and were able to pair. To move files from or to your phone, connecting it using a USB connection is your best option. One bug we noticed was that if you want to view or move your photos and videos, you'll need to connect your device using the Picture Transfer Protocol (PTP) and not the Media Transfer Protocol (MTP). In PTP, it was easy to view all the photos and videos in the default Videos application, without any problems.

ENSO

Android devices fail to pair via Bluetooth, although they are discoverable. We tried to connect the OnePlus X and Mi 5 to our testing machine but they failed to connect. Even pairing the iPad Pro to the machine failed. Detecting Android devices with a USB connection was fast and so was viewing images from the device's storage. However, playing videos using the default Parole Media Player and even VLC Media Player wasn't possible and they had to be copied locally to play them.

CONCLUSION

It's difficult to pick one of the two since both of them are ridden with some minor and a few major bugs. In terms of resource usage, you will be at an advantage with Elementary, owing to the fewer packages that are pre-installed. It's debatable and also a personal preference whether only the bare-minimum packages should be installed by the developers. The choice of Epiphany in Elementary is questionable because of its poor support for online video services and poor memory management.

With Enso, the interface isn't as smooth and responsive as Elementary, although both of them look clean. The smaller footprint of Elementary does help if you're installing it on a system with less powerful hardware than our testing rig. The applications you don't prefer using can be uninstalled easily and replaced with your favourite alternative. There are many such factors why Elementary is better than Enso, mainly because of the several years of work that has gone into it. An argument that can be made for Enso is that it's a distro that can be directly used without the need of installing extra applications. But you will have to deal with the random stuttering and bugs in as mentioned above. Enso is indeed interesting, as it caught our attention on release. We will surely keep an eye on how Enso gets rid of its issues while adding more features. 